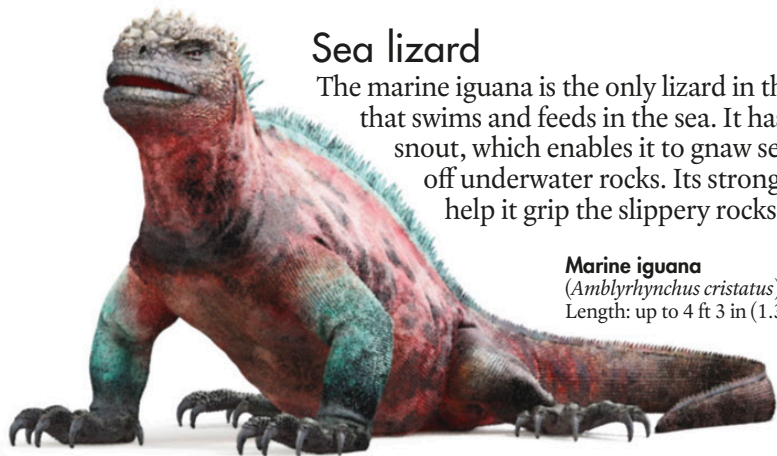




Sea lizard

The marine iguana is the only lizard in the world that swims and feeds in the sea. It has a short snout, which enables it to gnaw seaweed off underwater rocks. Its strong claws help it grip the slippery rocks.

Marine iguana
(*Amblyrhynchus cristatus*)
Length: up to 4 ft 3 in (1.3 m)



Woodpecker finch
(*Geospiza pallida*)
Length: up to 6 in (15 cm)

Trusty tools

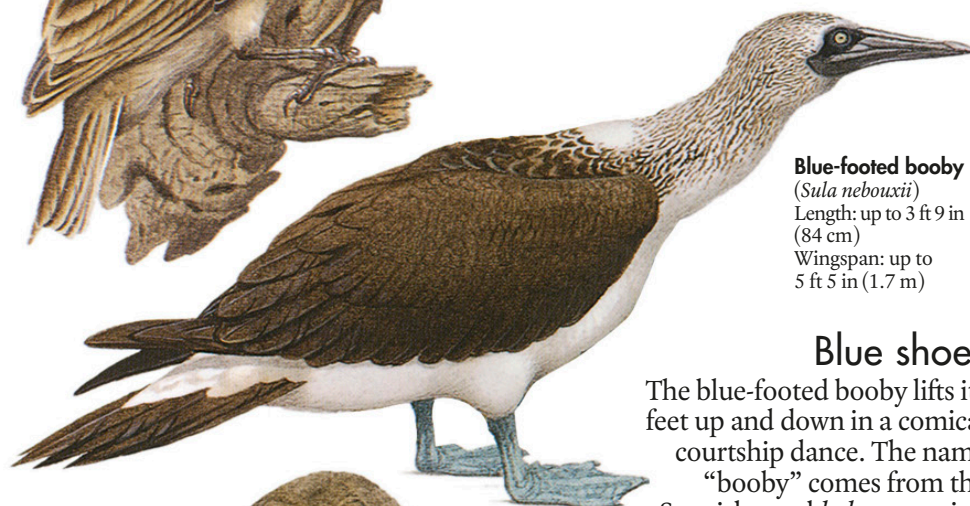
Unusually, the woodpecker finch uses a tool to help it find food. This bird feeds on insect grubs, which live under the bark or inside the trunks of trees. It uses a small twig or cactus spine to dig them out. The woodpecker finch may even make the tool itself by breaking a twig to the right length.

Pirate of the air

The frigate bird is named after a ship that was often used by pirates. When it sees another bird carrying food, the frigate bird flies after it and forces it to drop the food. Then it swoops down and grabs the stolen food in mid-air. During courtship, the male puffs out his red throat pouch to attract a female.



Magnificent frigate bird
(*Fregata magnificens*)
Length: up to 3 ft 8 in (1.1 m). Wingspan: up to 8 ft (2.4 m)



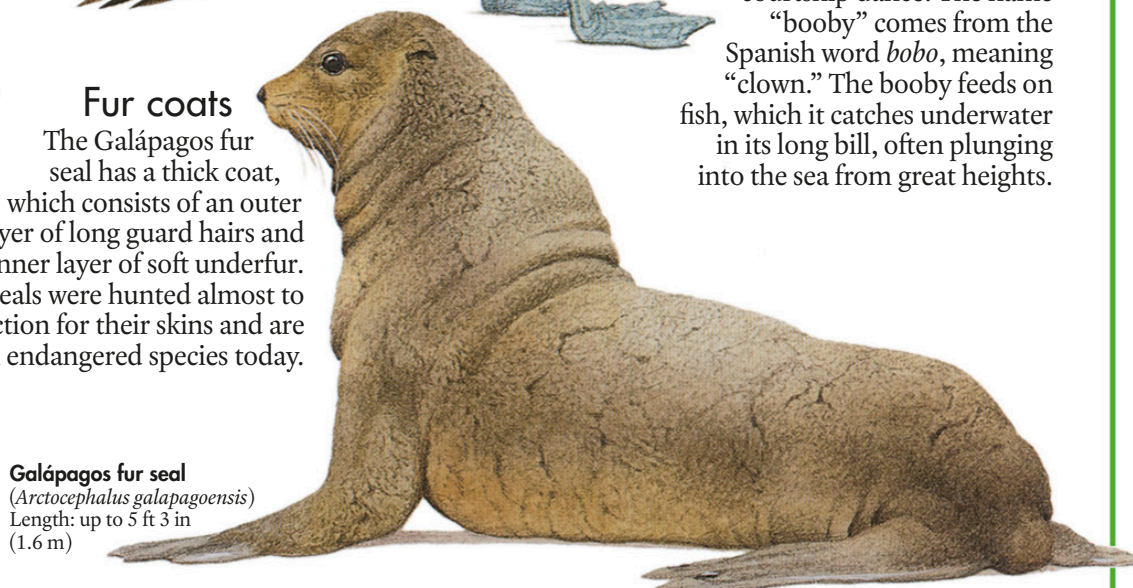
Blue-footed booby
(*Sula nebouxii*)
Length: up to 3 ft 9 in (84 cm)
Wingspan: up to 5 ft 5 in (1.7 m)

Blue shoes

The blue-footed booby lifts its feet up and down in a comical courtship dance. The name "booby" comes from the Spanish word *bobo*, meaning "clown." The booby feeds on fish, which it catches underwater in its long bill, often plunging into the sea from great heights.

Fur coats

The Galápagos fur seal has a thick coat, which consists of an outer layer of long guard hairs and an inner layer of soft underfur. These seals were hunted almost to extinction for their skins and are still an endangered species today.



Galápagos fur seal
(*Arctocephalus galapagoensis*)
Length: up to 5 ft 3 in (1.6 m)

Unique penguin

The Galápagos penguin is the only penguin found on the equator. It can survive in the Galápagos because of a water current that sweeps past the islands, carrying cold water from the Antarctic.

MAGNIFICENT FRIGATE BIRD



ISLA SAN CRISTÓBAL



Galápagos penguin
(*Spheniscus mendiculus*)
Height: up to 21 in (53 cm)

Fly catcher

The little vermilion flycatcher often perches on the back of a giant tortoise so that it can snap up flies disturbed by the tortoise's feet. The male bird has bright red feathers, which he shows off by flying overhead in a display to attract a mate.



Little vermilion flycatcher
(*Pyrocephalus nanus*)
Length: up to 5.5 in (14 cm)

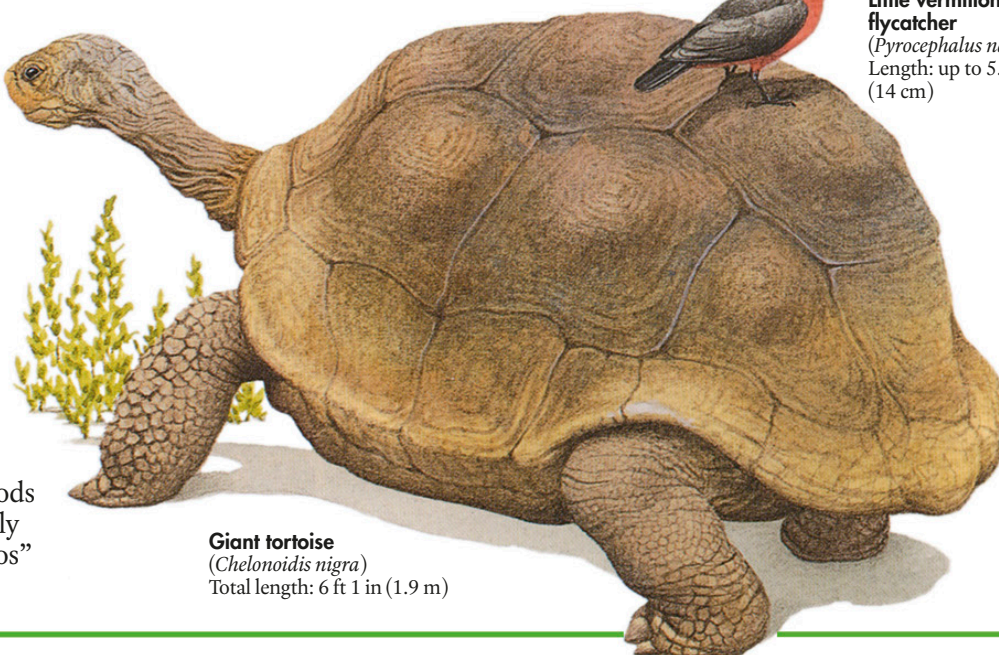
Super shells

The Galápagos are home to several different species of giant tortoises, which live on different islands. Each species has developed a slightly differently shaped shell to suit its habitat and diet. Giant tortoises have survived on the islands because they can go for long periods without food or water and can move easily over rough ground. The name "Galápagos" comes from a Spanish word for tortoise.



BLUE-FOOTED BOOBY

ISLA ESPAÑOLA



Giant tortoise
(*Chelonoidis nigra*)
Total length: 6 ft 1 in (1.9 m)